For Ratan, it was an opportunity he didn't want to miss. He also understood the 'appeal of foreign brands in emerging markets', commented *The Economist* in 2012. Coincidentally, Ratan also had an emotional connection with the Jaguar. His father, Naval Tata, used to drive one of the Jaguar's best-loved models, the XK120. He has fond memories of going on drives with his father in the car.

Ratan kept an eye on Ford's plans. He was on a high after steering Tata Motors to an all-time EBITDA of Rs 4181.9 crore ($924.19m) in 2007, with a growth of 229 per cent for the period 2003–07. The company now bristled with the confidence to take on any challenge—domestic or foreign.

Steering the Wheel

On 24 August 2007, Ratan put speculations to rest by confirming that Tata Motors was interested in acquiring the Jaguar and Land Rover brands. As he told the *Los Angeles Times*, 'What attracted us was the fact that these are two iconic brands, global in nature and highly respected for their products.' He emphasized that the 'bid for the two auto marquees were not merely meant to make the group's international presence felt', but also to get it the 'kind of scales and think big'. He told *The New York Times* in 2008, 'We were so dependent on one economy. I decided we needed a broader view.'

However, while Ratan acknowledged that 'Land Rover fitted in on top' of Tata Motors' 'SUV business', he was not so keen on the Jaguar, despite his emotional connect with it. He said that Tata Motors 'didn't know' what they 'would do with [the] Jaguar'. As he remarked later in an interview given to Harvard Business School, 'What did we know about premium cars?'

But he had no choice. Ford insisted that it would only sell both the brands together, says Kant. Ratan said that 'Ford refused to separate the two' because 'it was integrated in terms of manufacturing facilities' and 'it was very difficult to pull them apart'. Therefore, he decided to bid for both.

Once he had decided on making the acquisition, Ratan handpicked two teams. The first consisted of Ravi Kant; C. Ramakrishnan, CFO of Tata Motors; and Arun Gandhi. The second consisted of Rajiv Dube, president, passenger cars division, and Praveen Kadle. While Kant and Ramakrishnan's roles involved focusing on the negotiations with the Ford